

Ideation Phase
Define the Problem Statements

Date	1 NOVEMBER 2025
Team ID	NM2025TMID07302
Project Name	Calculating Family Expenses using Service Now
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Customer Problem Statement:

Who is the customer?

The primary customers are families and individuals who require a smart, automated, and centralized system to monitor income, spending, and savings efficiently within a shared digital environment.

What is the problem?

Families often struggle with:

- Disorganized and manual tracking of expenses across various categories.
- Difficulty linking daily expenses to overall household budgets.
- Limited visibility into spending patterns, leading to poor financial planning.
- Lack of automation in monitoring budgets, which can result in overspending without timely alerts.

Why is this problem important to solve?

Without a reliable financial tracking system:

- Families may struggle to maintain control over their expenses and savings.
- Monthly overspending can occur without timely alerts or reports.
- Manual tracking increases the risk of data errors and loss of important records.
- Long-term financial goals like saving, investment planning, or debt reduction become harder to achieve.

How does the customer currently address this problem?

Many families rely on manual methods such as spreadsheets, paper records, or basic mobile apps that are not linked, lack automation, and do not provide comprehensive reports or budget tracking features.

What is the desired outcome?

A smart, automated, and integrated system that:

- Enables easy entry and categorization of expenses for every family member.
- Generates visual dashboards for quick insight into spending habits and savings.
- Automatically compares actual expenses with monthly budget limits and issues alerts for overspending.
- Provides a unified and secure platform for managing all household financial data.
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Empathy and Customer Viewpoint:

By focusing on these needs, the solution aims to empower families with tools that not only simplify expense tracking but also promote financial discipline, better planning, and peace of mind.

I am	Describe customer with 3-4 key characteristics - who are they?	A family member or head of household responsible for managing and monitoring family finances, aiming for organized tracking and staying within budget.
I'm trying to	List their outcome or "job" the care about - what are they trying to achieve?	Track daily and family-level expenses efficiently, link them to the overall household budget, and gain insights into spending patterns.
but	Describe what problems or barriers stand in the way - what bothers them most?	Manual tracking methods are disorganized and time-consuming, making it difficult to monitor spending accurately or on time.
because	Enter the "root cause" of why the problem or barrier exists - what needs to be solved?	There is no centralized, automated system that links daily expenses to the family budget or provides timely alerts and clear reports.
which makes me feel	Describe the emotions from the customer's point of view - how does it impact them emotionally?	Stressed, anxious about overspending, and frustrated by the effort required to manage expenses manually without clarity.

Customer Type	Needs / Expectations	Pain Points	Emotions / Impact	Proposed Solution through ServiceNow
Family Member	Wants a simple way to record daily expenses	Finds it hard to track and remember all purchases	Feels unorganized and uncertain about spending	A personal expense entry form that automatically adds to a shared family expense table
Family Head / Budget Owner	Needs visibility of total monthly spending and category breakdown	No automated alerts for overspending	Feels anxious about exceeding budgets	Dashboards and budget threshold notifications to monitor total and category-wise expenses
Student / Dependent	Wants to manage pocket expenses within family limits	Manual tracking is confusing and time-consuming	Feels disconnected from family financial planning	Simplified mobile-friendly forms linked to the main ServiceNow expense tracker
Financial Planner (Family)	Needs summarized and categorized reports for analysis	Data scattered across different apps or files	Feels unsupported in decision-making	Automated reports and visual analytics from ServiceNow to identify spending patterns
Tech-Savvy Family Member	Expects automation and efficiency in data entry and reporting	Current tools lack workflow automation	Feels frustrated and less productive	ServiceNow workflows, business rules, and UI forms to automate calculations and updates